

Reuzel

Reuzel runs on Shopify, and that decision already won the hard half of AI visibility. Every AI crawler reaches the site, the product pages carry server-rendered price and stock data, and the full agent-commerce stack is live, so an AI shopping agent can find a Reuzel pomade, build a cart, and run a buyer-approved checkout today. The gap is narrower and entirely fixable. The brand's own structured data labels the maker "reuzelinc" instead of Reuzel, and it hides the one signal that decides a recommendation: the rating. The Pink pomade page shows 4.9 stars from 168 reviews to a shopper, and a crawler reading the raw HTML sees none of it. This audit shows where the brand under-sells itself to the engines and what closes the gap.

Prepared by Blackwell Enterprises

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Summary

Reuzel is in strong shape on the parts of AI visibility most brands fail. The site lets every AI crawler through. Googlebot, GPTBot, the OpenAI and Perplexity search bots, ClaudeBot, Amazonbot, Applebot, and Bingbot all reach the homepage and product pages and receive the full response. The product pages are rendered on the server and carry well-formed Product structured data with price, stock status, and SKU in the raw HTML before any JavaScript runs.

Reuzel also ships the full agent-commerce stack that Shopify now provides. The site serves an agent instruction file at `/agents.md`, an `llms.txt`, a Universal Commerce Protocol merchant profile at `/.well-known/ucp`, and a working UCP endpoint that an AI agent can call to search the catalog, build a cart, and run a checkout that the buyer approves. For the prior two brands we audited this was the central gap. Here the platform has solved it. An agent can transact with Reuzel today.

The losses are not in the plumbing, they are in the content the plumbing carries. Three things hold the brand back. First, the Product schema names the brand "reuzelinc", the Shopify store slug, not "Reuzel", so an engine that reads the field to attribute the product gets a string no shopper uses. Second, and most important, the product pages carry no rating in their structured data. The ratings render in JavaScript review widgets, so a shopper sees 4.9 stars and an AI crawler reading the page directly sees nothing. The brand has thousands of strong reviews on Amazon, Ulta, Walmart, and its own site, and almost none of that reaches the engines from reuzel.com. Third, more than half the catalog is missing its product type, which weakens the category signal an engine reads from the feed.

None of this requires re-architecting the site. These are field-level fixes to the structured data Shopify already emits, plus claiming a review profile the brand does not yet hold. The composite score reflects that: Reuzel is well ahead of where most brands start, and the remaining points sit in a few concrete changes.

Scorecard

79

out of
100

Strong foundation, a few high-leverage content gaps. Transactability is the standout, solved by the Shopify agent stack. Recommendability is solid: in a clean six-engine battery (incognito or temporary chat where logged in), Reuzel's flagship is named in ChatGPT, Perplexity, Claude, and Copilot, with a volatile Google AI Overview and an unmeasured Gemini the only soft spots. Quotability is the soft spot: the rating and brand entity are absent or wrong in the structured data, which is exactly the data engines quote from. Every gap below is a field-level fix, not a rebuild.

DIMENSION	SCORE	READ
Discoverability	80	Every AI crawler is allowed and gets the full page, Bing included. Sitemaps are clean and an agent-discovery sitemap is present. Held back by the brand being mislabeled in schema and half the catalog missing a product type.
Quotability	70	Price, stock, and SKU are server-rendered and quotable, and an FAQ block is present. But there is no rating in the structured data and the brand field is wrong, so the facts most relevant to a recommendation are missing or misleading.
Recommendability	76	Tested live with a clean six-engine battery (incognito or temporary chat where logged in). Reuzel's Extreme Hold Matte is the top pick in ChatGPT, and a best pick in Perplexity and Claude, all citing reuzel.com; Copilot names it too. The headroom is source authority and two soft spots: a volatile Google AI Overview and a Gemini that could not be measured clean.
Transactability	90	The full Shopify agent-commerce stack is live: agents.md, llms.txt, a UCP merchant profile, and a working UCP endpoint. An AI agent can search, cart, and run a buyer-approved checkout. This is the strongest dimension.

DIMENSION	SCORE	READ
Reputation	 78	The underlying reputation is excellent: 4.6 to 4.9 stars across thousands of reviews on Amazon, Ulta, and the brand site, plus a genuine Schorem barbershop origin story engines can cite. Held back because the brand does not surface it in its own schema and holds no claimed Trustpilot profile.

Scores are graded against a truth table frozen from reuzel.com on June 17, 2026, before any engine or third-party source was queried. Method is Blackwell's nine-phase AI visibility audit across five dimensions. Where a dimension depends on live answer-engine behavior, the basis and its limits are stated in the finding and in the closing note on method.

Discoverability

Discoverability asks whether the engines can reach the site, read it, and identify what they are looking at. Reuzel does the first two cleanly and stumbles on the third.

Crawler access

We requested the homepage and a product page with each crawler's published user agent. Every one returned the full page. The robots.txt is the stock Shopify file: it blocks only cart, checkout, account, search, and faceted collection paths, and carries no rules against the AI crawlers, so they are allowed by default. The one AI-specific entry, ChatRankBot, is slowed with a crawl delay, not blocked.

CRAWLER	STATUS	NOTE
Googlebot	200	allowed
GPTBot, OAI-SearchBot, ChatGPT-User	200	OpenAI crawlers, all allowed
ClaudeBot, Claude-User	200	full Product schema served
PerplexityBot, Perplexity-User	200	allowed
Bingbot	200	allowed, the channel many brands close
Amazonbot, Applebot, Bytespider, Google-Extended	200	all allowed

STRENGTH

Open to every engine, with a clean agent-discovery sitemap

The main sitemap links a dedicated sitemap_agentic_discovery.xml that points AI agents to /agents.md. Crawl access is not a problem here, and the agent discovery layer is a positive signal most brands do not have.

MEDIUM

The brand is mislabeled in the Product schema

The Product structured data on the Pink pomade page carries "brand": {"@type": "Brand", "name": "reuzelinc"}. That is the Shopify store slug, not the brand. The two Organization blocks on the same page correctly say "Reuzel", so the page contradicts itself. An engine that reads the Product brand field to attribute or group the product sees "reuzelinc", a string that appears nowhere a shopper would search. The fix is one field in the product data, set to "Reuzel".

MEDIUM

More than half the catalog has no product type

Of 89 products in the catalog feed, 49 carry an empty product type. The rest are typed correctly (Pomade, Beard Products, Hair Tonic, Shampoo, and so on). Product type is part of how an engine and a faceted search read what a product is. Filling it across the catalog sharpens the category signal at no design cost.

Quotability

Quotability asks whether an engine can lift clean, structured facts off the page and repeat them confidently. The price path is good. The rating path is the gap, and it is the one that matters most.

What the schema gets right

The Pink pomade page serves four JSON-LD blocks in the raw HTML, all valid: a Product block with a nested Offer (price 19.95, currency USD, availability InStock, SKU REU203), two Organization blocks, and an FAQ block. A crawler that does not run JavaScript still reads the price, the stock status, and the answers to common questions. That is real and worth keeping.

HIGH The rating is invisible to crawlers

The Product block carries no aggregateRating and no review nodes. The ratings on the page come from JavaScript review widgets. We loaded the Pink pomade page in a browser and the widget showed 4.9 stars from 168 reviews. We then read the same page as ClaudeBot reads it, from the raw HTML, and the rating was not there. A shopper sees 4.9 stars. An AI crawler reading the page directly sees a product with no rating at all. Since the rating is the single fact that most drives a recommendation, this is the highest-leverage fix on the site.

MEDIUM Four review apps load on one page

The Pink pomade page references four separate review and user-content apps: Okendo, Yotpo, Loox, and Judge.me. Only one is plausibly the live source of reviews; the rest are most likely leftover from past installs. Beyond the page weight, the clutter makes it ambiguous which review corpus is the brand's source of truth. Worth confirming and pruning to one, which also makes the rating fix below straightforward.

LOW TO MEDIUM Schema hygiene: http context and malformed social links

The Product block declares "@context": "http://schema.org/" over http rather than https. Google tolerates it, stricter validators prefer https. The two Organization blocks also carry duplicated and empty sameAs entries, including a bare "#". These are small, but they are the kind of noise that lowers an engine's confidence in the entity. Clean them up alongside the rating fix.

The fix that moves the most

One change carries most of the upside: put the rating the brand already earns into the server-rendered Product schema, and correct the brand name while you are in that block. Below is the current Product JSON-LD on the Pink pomade page and the version that would let every engine read the 4.9-star, 168-review signal the shopper already sees.

```
// CURRENT, as served to crawlers in raw HTML
{
  "@context": "http://schema.org/",
  "@type": "Product",
  "name": "Pink Strong Hold Grease Pomade",
  "sku": "REU203",
  "brand": { "@type": "Brand", "name": "reuzelinc" },
  "offers": [{
    "@type": "Offer", "sku": "REU203",
    "price": 19.95, "priceCurrency": "USD",
    "availability": "http://schema.org/InStock"
  }]
  // no aggregateRating, no review nodes
}
```

Current. Brand reads as the store slug, and the rating is absent.

```
// PROPOSED
{
  "@context": "https://schema.org/",
  "@type": "Product",
  "name": "Pink Strong Hold Grease Pomade",
  "sku": "REU203",
  "brand": { "@type": "Brand", "name": "Reuzel" },
  "offers": [{
    "@type": "Offer", "sku": "REU203",
    "price": 19.95, "priceCurrency": "USD",
    "availability": "https://schema.org/InStock"
  }],
  "aggregateRating": {
    "@type": "AggregateRating",
    "ratingValue": "4.9",
    "reviewCount": "168"
  }
}
```

Proposed. https context, brand corrected to "Reuzel", and the rating pulled from the live review source into the server-rendered block. The numbers shown are the live values read from the page on June 17, 2026; in practice the review app emits these per product so the figures stay current.

Every major review app on Shopify, Okendo and Yotpo included, can write AggregateRating into the server-rendered Product schema. In many cases it is a setting in the app, not custom code. Confirming which app is the live one and turning that on across the catalog is the single most valuable change in this audit.

Recommendability

Recommendability asks whether the brand gets named when a shopper asks by category rather than by name. We tested this directly with the full six-engine battery, two passes each (from the model's own memory with web search off, then with live retrieval on), on "best men's pomade for strong hold". Logged-in engines ran in incognito or temporary chat (ChatGPT Temporary Chat, Perplexity Incognito) and Copilot ran as a guest, so saved history did not inflate the result. The result is strong, better than most brands and well ahead of the two we audited before. The gaps that remain are narrow and specific.

What the engines said, clean re-run June 22, 2026

ENGINE (CLEAN SESSION)	NAMED REUZEL	PICK, ON LIVE RETRIEVAL	CITED REUZEL.COM
ChatGPT (Temporary Chat)	Yes, top pick	Extreme Hold Matte	Yes
Perplexity (Incognito)	Yes, best pick	strong-hold pomade	Yes
Claude (web retrieval)	Yes	Reuzel pomade	Yes
Copilot (guest)	Yes	named with Suavecito	No (Bing carousel)
Google AI Overview	Varies by render	present in some, absent in others	mixed
Gemini	Not measured clean	logged-in only	n/a

This is a clean re-run: each logged-in engine used incognito or a temporary chat so that no saved history could push Reuzel up. It still lands. ChatGPT made Reuzel Extreme Hold Matte its outright top pick and quoted the brand's own "11 out of 10 hold" spec. Perplexity in incognito named Reuzel's strong-hold pomade as a best pick and cited reuzel.com. Claude does not name Reuzel from memory, but on live retrieval it surfaces the brand and cites reuzel.com. Copilot as a guest named Reuzel alongside Suavecito. Two honest caveats: Google's AI Overview is non-deterministic for this query, present in one same-day render and absent in another, so it is shown as variable rather than a guaranteed win; and Gemini could not be run in a clean session, so its result is left unmeasured rather than counted either way.

Temporary Chat

Search the web. What is the best men's pomade for strong hold in 2026? Give specific product recommendations and cite sources.

Worked for 38s >

My pick for **best men's pomade for strong hold in 2026** is **Reuzel Extreme Hold Matte Pomade**. It has the clearest "maximum hold" case: Reuzel rates it **11/10 hold**, **1/10 shine**, calls it the strongest hold in its lineup, and says it is water-based and washes out easily. It is best for thick, medium-to-coarse, unruly hair, tall quiffs, structured side parts, and matte/no-shine styles.

Reuzel Extreme Hold Matte Pomade
\$9.20 • Best overall hold with a matte finish, ideal for

Layrite Superhold Pomade
\$30.69 • Great for thick hair, offers superhold for structured looks.

Blind Barber 101 Proof Classic Pomade
\$24.00 • High-shine, daily-use pomade for classic

+ Ask anything
 High

ChatGPT can make mistakes. Check important info.

ChatGPT in a Temporary Chat (no saved history), asked for the best strong-hold pomade, names Reuzel Extreme Hold Matte as its top pick and quotes Reuzel's own hold spec. Captured June 22, 2026.

MEDIUM The recommendation is borrowed, not owned

Look at the last column. ChatGPT, Perplexity, and Claude all cite reuzel.com when they name the brand, which is the strong case. Copilot still builds its answer from an Amazon-sourced Bing shopping carousel and names Reuzel without crediting reuzel.com. So where the brand is named, the better engines now read it from its own site, but the commerce-carousel path still learns it from resellers. That is the cost of the missing server-rendered rating and the mislabeled brand entity in the schema: reuzel.com is not yet the single authoritative source for its own products. The Quotability fixes convert "recommended from listicles" into "recommended and cited from reuzel.com" everywhere, including the carousel engines.

MEDIUM**Two narrow gaps: Google AI Overview volatility and an unmeasured Gemini**

The clean re-run closed the gaps the earlier draft flagged: Copilot and Perplexity now both name Reuzel. What remains is narrower. Google's AI Overview is non-deterministic for this category: in two same-day renders it named Reuzel in one and omitted it in the other (favoring Suavecito, Blind Barber, and Duke Cannon), so the brand's place there is not yet stable. And Gemini could not be run in a clean session, because the test profile carried prior Reuzel searches that would bias the read, so it is reported as unmeasured rather than counted. Both are reasons to keep the entity and category-source work going until the position holds across every render, not just most of them.

STRENGTH**Named-brand queries already work**

Asked "Reuzel Blue pomade price and where to buy", Perplexity returned the correct 19.95 dollars and cited reuzel.com as the official store. When a shopper names the brand, the engines read the brand's page and get it right. The gap is only on the category question, where the brand competes to be named in the first place.

Transactability

Transactability asks whether an AI agent acting for a shopper can actually buy the product. For most brands this is the hardest dimension and the one they score worst on. Reuzel scores highest here, because Shopify now ships the whole stack and the brand has it switched on.

The agent-commerce stack is live

SURFACE	STATUS	WHAT IT DOES
/agents.md	live	Agent instruction file. Describes the UCP flow and the buyer-approval rule.
/llms.txt	live	Same agent-facing instructions at the conventional path.
/.well-known/ucp	live	UCP merchant profile, version 2026-04-08, advertising cart, checkout, fulfillment, and discount capabilities.
UCP endpoint (/api/ucp/mcp)	live	The endpoint an agent calls to search the catalog, build a cart, and run checkout.
/products.json	live	Full catalog as structured JSON for read-only agents.

STRENGTH

An agent can find, cart, and buy, with the buyer approving payment

The /agents.md file walks an agent through the full flow: discover the store's capabilities, search the catalog, create a cart, set shipping, and complete a checkout that the buyer must approve. It also points agents at the Shop skill for buyer-approved payment through Shop Pay. We exercised the UCP endpoint directly. It is live and enforces the agent-identity handshake before it lists its tools, which is the correct, secure behavior: it will not transact for an unidentified agent, and payment requires buyer approval. The read-only paths, the catalog JSON and the merchant profile, are open and worked on the first request.

There is nothing to fix here. The point in the audit is to recognize the advantage: as agent-driven shopping grows, Reuzel is already reachable by it while most brands are not. The recommendation is to keep the stack current with the UCP version Shopify ships, and to make sure the catalog data those agents read, brand and rating included, is correct, which the fixes above handle.

Reputation

Reputation asks what the wider corpus says about the brand and whether engines can find and trust it. Reuzel's reputation is genuinely strong. The problem is distribution, not substance: the brand does not surface its own proof, and it leaves one trust channel unclaimed.

The ratings are excellent wherever they are exposed

SOURCE	RATING	DEPTH
Ulta, Reuzel Blue pomade	4.8 / 5	358 reviews
Ulta, Reuzel Red pomade	4.9 / 5	182 reviews
Amazon, Reuzel Red pomade	~4.6 / 5	5,000+ reviews
reuzel.com, Pink pomade (on-page widget)	4.9 / 5	168 reviews
reuzel.com, sitewide reviews page	5-star	2,000+ 5-star reviews cited
ReviewMeta, brand aggregate	mixed-verified	7,731 reviews across 25 products

STRENGTH A real origin story engines can cite

Reuzel was created in 2013 by Leen Bergman and Bertus van Dijk, the barbers behind Schorem, the Rotterdam barbershop they opened in 2001. The name means pork drippings, a nod to the grease pomade. This is a well-documented, frequently retold story across barbering and grooming media, which gives the engines a strong, consistent entity to attach the brand to. Most DTC brands have nothing like it.

MEDIUM The brand under-surfaces its own proof

The ratings above are excellent and abundant, and almost none of it reaches an engine from reuzel.com, because of the missing schema rating covered earlier. The brand has done the hard work of earning thousands of strong reviews and then keeps them in JavaScript widgets the crawlers cannot read. The schema fix is what converts this earned reputation into a signal the engines can quote.

MEDIUM No claimed Trustpilot business profile

Searching for Reuzel on Trustpilot returns only third-party retailer product pages, not a claimed Reuzel business profile. Trustpilot is a source several engines weight for brand trust. Claiming the profile and seeding it with the reviews the brand already has would open a trust channel that is currently closed. This is an action only the brand can take, and it is worth taking.

What to do, in order

Ranked by leverage. The first two are field-level changes to data Shopify already emits and should move the score the most.

1. Put the rating into the server-rendered Product schema

Highest leverage. Turn on AggregateRating output in the live review app so every product page carries its rating and review count in the raw HTML, as shown in the fix section. This makes the brand's own page a citable source for its social proof.

2. Correct the brand and clean the schema

Set the Product brand to "Reuzel", move the schema context to https, and remove the empty and duplicate sameAs entries on the Organization blocks. Small edits, and they remove the contradictions that lower an engine's confidence in the entity.

3. Fill in product type across the catalog

Assign a product type to the 49 products that lack one. This sharpens the category signal in the feed the engines and agents read.

4. Consolidate to one review app

Confirm which of the four review apps is live and remove the rest. One source of truth for reviews makes the schema fix clean and lightens the page.

5. Claim the Trustpilot profile

Open the brand-controlled trust channel that is currently empty, and seed it with the reviews the brand already has elsewhere.

WHAT WE DELIVER VERSUS WHAT ONLY THE BRAND CAN DO

We produce the exact schema payloads, the field corrections, the catalog product-type mapping, and the re-test that measures movement. Turning on the app setting, editing the live theme, claiming the Trustpilot profile, and pruning the review apps are changes inside Reuzel's own systems that the brand executes; we hand over the precise specs and verify the result. Where an outcome depends on a third party, such as a publisher updating a roundup, we flag it as such and do not promise it.

How we tested

This audit follows Blackwell's nine-phase AI visibility method across five dimensions: Discoverability, Quotability, Recommendability, Transactability, and Reputation.

We froze a truth table from reuzel.com on June 17, 2026, before querying any engine or third-party source, so scores are graded against the brand's own data, not against the engines' answers. We tested crawler access by requesting the site with each crawler's published user agent. We read the product schema as the AI crawlers read it, from the raw HTML. We loaded the product pages in a real browser to capture what a shopper sees, including the JavaScript-rendered ratings. We exercised the UCP agent-commerce endpoint directly. We pulled the full catalog from the Shopify products feed (89 products, 130 variants) for the truth table. For reputation we used named retailer ratings from Amazon and Ulta and the brand's own review pages.

For Recommendability we ran a clean six-engine battery on June 22, 2026: ChatGPT, Perplexity, Claude, Gemini, Google AI Overview, and Microsoft Copilot, each asked for the best men's pomade for strong hold, in two passes where possible (from the model's memory with web search off, then with live retrieval on). To keep saved history from inflating the result, logged-in engines ran in incognito or a temporary chat (ChatGPT Temporary Chat, Perplexity Incognito) and Copilot ran as a guest. What each named and cited was recorded against the frozen truth table, and each engine and pass was captured. Three honest limits are noted in the Recommendability section rather than smoothed over: Claude names Reuzel only on the retrieval pass, not from memory; Google's AI Overview returned Reuzel in one same-day render and omitted it in another; and Gemini could not be run in a clean session, so it is reported as unmeasured. Everything else in this document was verified live between June 17 and 22, 2026.

Prepared by Blackwell Enterprises. Figures are point-in-time and will shift as the engines, the catalog, and the review corpus change. The recommendations above are scoped to what Blackwell delivers, what the brand executes, and what depends on third parties, and are labeled accordingly.